

GREGG WILLIAMS

Williams Surges Clear At The Turn

A four-hole blitz from the 8th hands Gregg Williams the outright TEG 8 Trophy lead despite a shaky finish.

Gregg Williams produced the standout round of the opening day at Quinta da Marinha. He carded 38 Stableford points. The field's worst score was 17, which tells you rather more about the field than it does about Williams.

The round turned through holes 8 to 11, where he gathered 14 points. The sequence read bogey, par, birdie, bogey. The bogey came at the 1st, the hardest hole on the course, and the birdie at the par-5 10th. That

birdie did more than fill a box. It took Williams to the outright lead in the 2015 TEG Trophy.

Then the structure gave way. Over holes 12 to 15 he shipped ten shots. Double bogeys at the 12th, 13th and 14th were merely the foundation work. The 15th, a par 4, took him 8, a quadruple bogey worth precisely nothing. He walked off it with the same 38 points he had before, which is one way of describing a hole. The total still led the day.

AT A GLANCE

ROUND OF THE DAY
Gregg WILLIAMS (38 pts)

TROPHY LEAD
Gregg WILLIAMS, 4 ahead

GREEN JACKET LEAD
David MULLIN, 1 ahead

ROUND STABLEFORD
GW 38 | JB 34 | AB 30 | DM 30 | HM 29 | SN 17
ROUND GROSS
DM +20 | JB +21 | GW +26 | HM +29 | AB +41 | SN +43

AFTER R1 • TROPHY
GW 38 | JB 34 | AB 30 | DM 30 | HM 29 | SN 17
AFTER R1 • GREEN JACKET
DM +20 | JB +21 | GW +26 | HM +29 | AB +41 | SN +43

WOODEN SPOON

Neumann Sets A New Low

A calamitous run from the 7th to the 15th leaves Stuart Neumann with the worst round in TEG history and an early lock on the Wooden Spoon.

Quinta da Marinha's opening round produced one horror show, and then improved on it. Henry Meller took a quintuple bogey at the 3rd and sank to the bottom of the TEG 8 Wooden Spoon table after three holes. It is an impressive pace to set. He did not hold the position long. Stuart Neumann's triple bogey at the 4th relieved him of

it, and Neumann then set about defending his claim with real commitment.

Between the 7th and the 15th he bled 29 shots. Nine consecutive holes passed without a single net par. Quadruple bogeys at the 10th and 11th were the calm portion. A quintuple bogey followed at the 12th, one of the hardest holes on

the course, and another at the 14th. He signed for 17 points and a gross 43. Both were personal worsts. It was also, at the time, the worst TEG Trophy round recorded in TEG history. Not the worst of the day. Not the worst of the tournament. The worst there had ever been. He sits at the foot of the TEG 8 Wooden Spoon table by a distance that will need surveying equipment.

GREEN JACKET

Mullin Takes Early Green Jacket Lead

David Mullin's par at the 13th settles a Green Jacket lead that changed hands three times inside the first round.

The Green Jacket lead changed hands three times before settling on the back end of the front nine at Quinta da Marinha. Jon Baker drew level with a bogey at the par-5 6th. David Mullin drew level in turn with a bogey at the par-5 10th. Gregg Williams then joined them with a bogey at the 11th. None of this constitutes golf in the

traditional sense. It did, however, set up the turning point: Mullin's par at the par-4 13th, one of the harder holes on the course, which took him outright into first.

Baker's reply arrived at the very same hole, and was a quintuple-bogey 9. It was the low point of

his round and he took it without visible complaint. He recovered with a bogey, then a double bogey, then a birdie at the 17th, which is the golfing equivalent of tidying the room after the fire. Mullin finished the day a single shot clear for the TEG 8 Green Jacket lead.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 8, Round 1

PERSONAL WORSTS

- Stuart Neumann's worst round to date: 17 pts
- Stuart Neumann's worst Gross round to date: +43

RARE FEATS

- Henry Meller runs up a 10 (+5) at the 3rd — his career-worst on a par-5
- Stuart Neumann runs up an 8 (+5) at the 14th — his career-worst on a par-3